YOUR PARENTING PROFILE



The Pandan Chiffon

P G T N

Light structure that rises with your child.

Your four letters

Your code is built from four research-backed parenting dimensions. Neither pole of any dimension is the better one.



P — HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY
Planner

G — WHO SETS THE DIRECTION
Gardener

T — WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG
Talker

N — COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE
Nester

For fun & reflection — not a clinical assessment or diagnostic tool.

AN EVERYDAY STORY

The No Beside the Candy Shelf

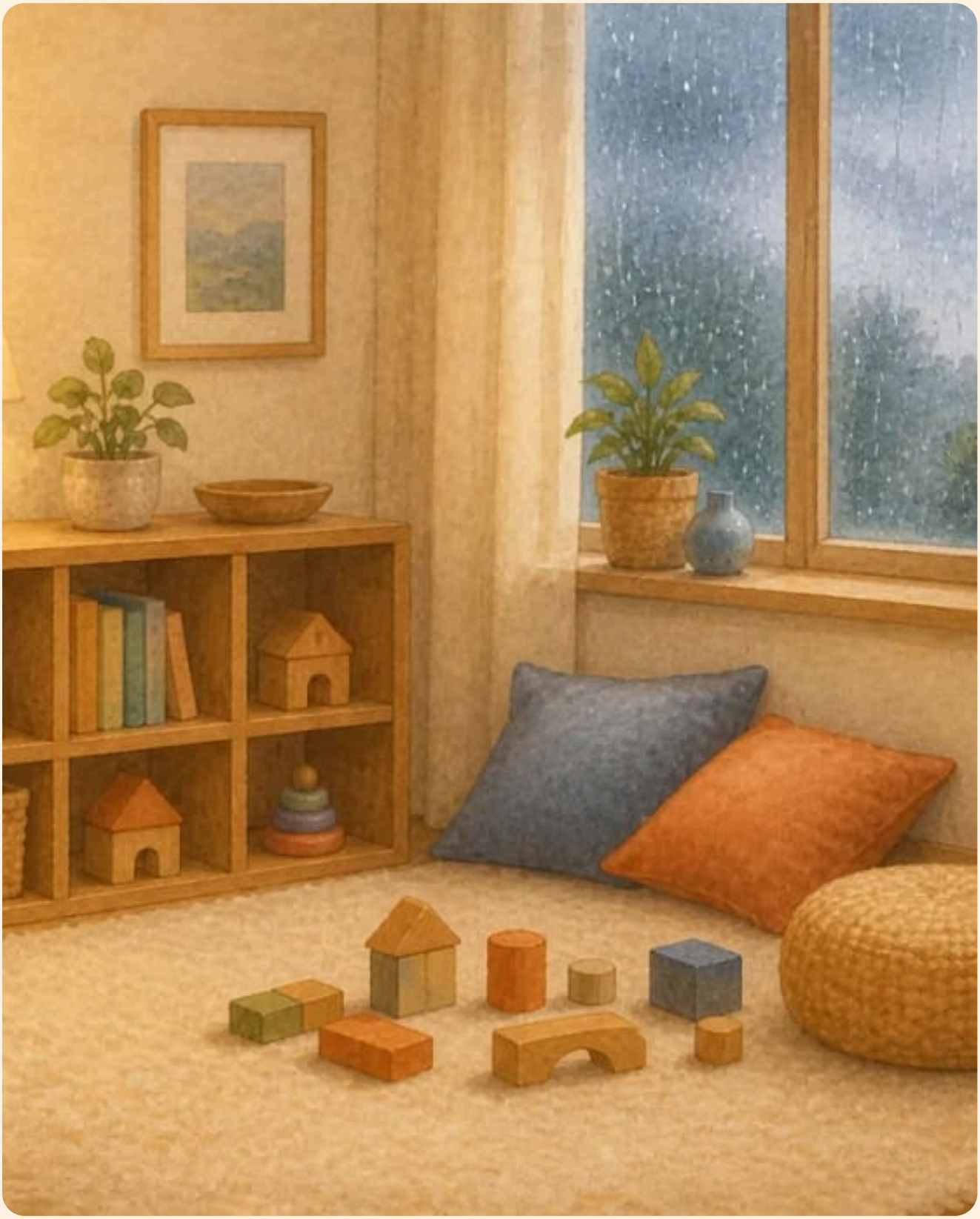
At the supermarket checkout, your child asks for candy. You say no gently. They ask again, louder. A minute later they are crying on the floor while people glance over their baskets. Your chest tightens. If I were truly gentle, you think, my child would not be this upset.

As a Pandan Chiffon parent, you notice every shift in a child's face. You make room for feelings so naturally that disappointment can start to feel like evidence that you caused harm. But softness without an edge eventually asks you to disappear.



You kneel down, not to change the answer but to steady yourself. “You really wanted it. You can be sad, and the answer is still no.” Then you stop explaining. Your body gets to keep one boundary too.

The crying does not end immediately. That is not proof the boundary failed. Outside, your child takes your hand and asks about the rain. Nothing in the relationship has broken. You were warm and firm in the same moment, the kind of soft structure that can rise without collapsing.



WHAT OFTEN HAPPENS

You are highly attuned to your child's signals and want home to stay gentle. Saying no or seeing disappointment can immediately feel as if you have hurt them.

RELEASE THE GUILT

A warm boundary is not rejection. Your child may be disappointed and still loved; you may be firm and still be a gentle parent.



YOUR SUPERPOWERS

1. You read your kid's cues like a pro
2. Soft landings for every big feeling
3. Unhurried presence, no rush, just here

WATCH-OUT, WITH LOVE

Gentle can drift into no-limits. Kids need edges too, soft ones still count. 🌿

YOUR POP-CULTURE COUSIN

Gentle parenting



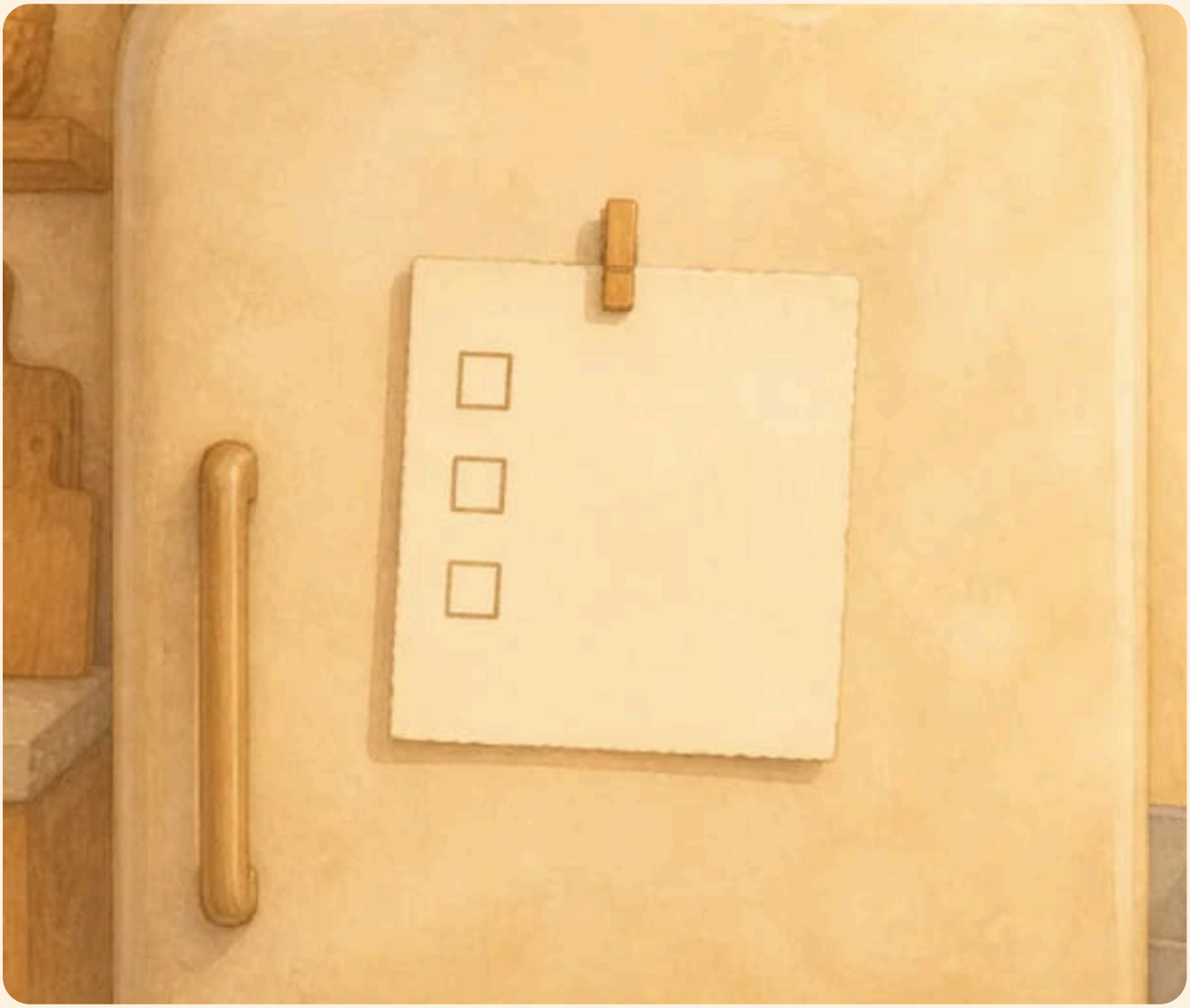
WHAT TO REMEMBER

Try this week

- [ ] Say one no without a long explanation
- [ ] Take a quiet pause
- [ ] Say: “You may feel sad, and the answer is still not yet.”

EXTRAS FOR YOUR STYLE

- [ ] Start one day this week with no list at all.
- [ ] Once this week, decide without offering a choice.
- [ ] Just once, listen all the way to the end without offering a solution.
- [ ] Hold back one "be careful" today.



FOR YOU FIRST

5 ways to come back to yourself

Chosen from your style: what you spend yourself on is what needs releasing. Not one of these is for your child.

There's an order most of us have backwards: everyone else gets looked after first, and you get whatever is left. But what's left at nine at night isn't you — it's the part of you that never got to rest.

The next five pages don't ask you to be a better parent. Nothing here is counted, nothing is reported, and not one of them is for your child. They're all for you, and they aren't a reward you have to earn first.

What's on them isn't random either. Every parenting style spends itself differently: some parents run out from anticipating, some from deciding, some from holding everybody's feelings. So whatever drains you most is also what most needs releasing.



WHAT DRAINS YOU MOST

P — HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY

Anticipating. Your head keeps running even when your body sits down.

G — WHO SETS THE DIRECTION

Waiting and holding back. Following someone else's pace all day is work.

T — WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG

Absorbing feelings. Your ears have been on shift since morning.

N — COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE

Vigilance. Everyone's sense of safety is parked with you.

FOR YOU FIRST

Honor one limit in your body or energy before it is depleted. Healthy gentleness includes you.

HOW TO USE THESE

Take just one. If only one of these gets used this week, that worked. The rest stay here; they aren't going anywhere.

No time this week? You are still enough.



TIME 5 MIN

One drink while it's still hot

Almost every parent drinks their coffee cold. Not from lack of time, but because there is always one more thing that comes first.

Sit down. Finish the whole thing at its actual temperature, doing nothing else at the same time.



TIME 15 MIN

An empty block on the calendar

If every hour has a name, there is nowhere for recovery to happen. This block succeeds by staying empty.

Put one block in the calendar with nothing in it. Defend it the way you'd defend a meeting with someone else.



TIME 15 MIN

Tend something that isn't your child

You're good at tending things that grow slowly. Fifteen minutes of care that reports to nobody and thanks you by growing.

Water the plants, prune something, feed the sourdough. Anything that grows and isn't your child.



TIME 2 MIN

Six long exhales

Two minutes, no equipment, can be done standing in the kitchen. For a parent who absorbs feelings all day, this is the cheapest reset there is.

Six breaths where the out-breath is longer than the in-breath. Slower than feels natural.



TIME 5 MIN

Five warm minutes

You are the one who makes everyone else feel safe. This time the comfort points at you, and that's allowed.

A warm shower, a warm blanket, or your hands around a warm mug — five minutes of comfortable warmth with nothing else happening.

5 activities with your child (0–5)

One for each age range, so you can take the one that fits your child right now. Everything is already in your house.



THEN, FOR YOUR CHILD

Your child needs empathy and a clear edge so they do not have to guess who is holding the situation.



0–12 MONTHS · 15 MIN

Treasure basket

Real objects are richer than plastic toys, and choosing independently is what makes the concentration last.

1. Fill a shallow basket with 5–6 real objects of different materials: wood, metal, fabric, natural.
2. Sit beside them and let them lead entirely.
3. Resist handing, demonstrating or naming unless they look up at you.

You'll need: A large wooden ring, a fabric square, a short chunky brush, a silicone cup, a metal measuring cup.

Safety first: Every object must be too big for a toilet-paper tube, unbreakable, with no coating that can flake and no cord or long handle.

Grounded in: Heuristic play / treasure basket



1–2 YEARS · 10 MIN

Move the water with a sponge

The water does the correcting, not you. The spill is part of the activity, not a failure of it.

1. Set two shallow bowls on a towel, one with a little water.
2. Show the squeeze once.
3. Put a small cloth beside them and let them mop it themselves.

You'll need: Two shallow bowls, one small sponge, a towel, a cloth.

Safety first: A very small amount of water, always within arm's reach. A toddler can drown in a few centimetres.

Grounded in: Montessori — practical life



2–3 YEARS · 15 MIN

Build the calm basket together

Assembling the box while nobody is upset works far better than looking for it mid-meltdown.

1. Offer a basket and ask what helps when their feelings get big.
2. Put in whatever they say, even if it seems useless to you.
3. Name the feelings that come up as you talk, without fixing them.

You'll need: A basket, plus their choices: a soft toy, a picture, a squeeze ball, a blanket.

Safety first: Every loose item must be too large for a toilet-paper tube. Nothing that can be tied, wrapped, or pulled over the head.

Grounded in: Play therapy — reflecting feelings



3–4 YEARS · 15 MIN

Draw anything, I'll just be here

"What is it?" makes a child guess the answer you want. Describing what you see asks nothing of them.

1. Paper and crayons, both of you at the table.
2. Describe colours, movements, choices — "you used a lot of blue there".
3. Never ask "what is it?", and never correct a colour or a shape.

You'll need: Paper and crayons.

Safety first: Use intact, non-toxic children's crayons. Stay close if your child still puts objects in their mouth.

Grounded in: Play therapy — reflecting feelings



4–5 YEARS · 10 MIN

One sentence each

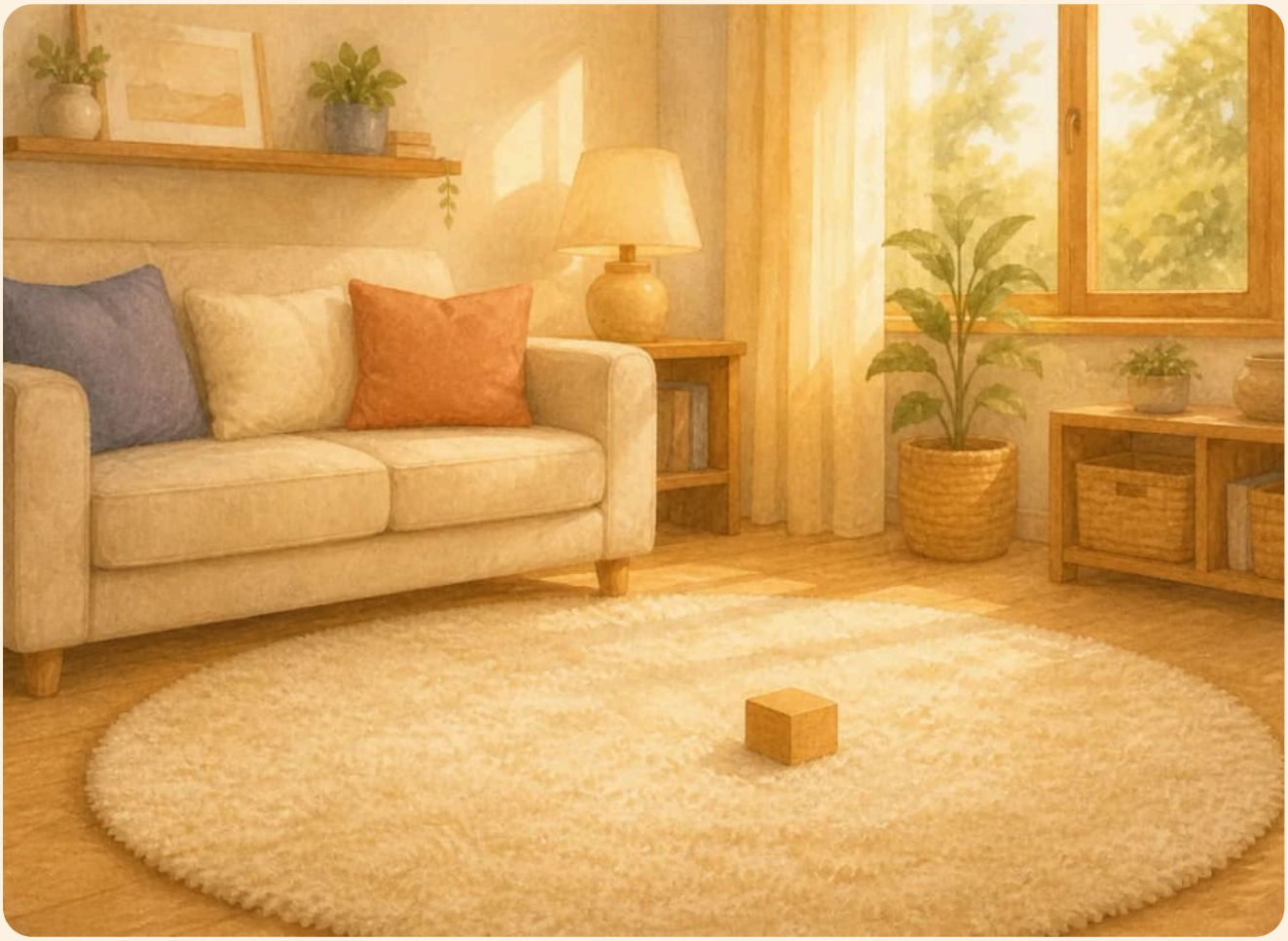
A story built by two people, slowly, before bed. Accepting their turn as it comes is another form of listening.

1. You start with one sentence, they add the next.
2. Accept every turn they take, including the ones that break your plot.
3. When they end it, it's ended.

You'll need: Nothing at all.

Safety first: If the story becomes upsetting, stop or change direction. This is not a test and never needs to be finished.

Grounded in: Play therapy — reflecting feelings



No play today? You are still enough.

Keep it, print it, or forget it

This booklet has no targets and counts nothing. Take the one thing that helps and leave the rest.



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